

Christos Hadjinikolis

Engineering Manager | Applied AI & Production Systems
Ph.D. Computer Science | UCL Research Associate | AI Standards
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profiles

website

LinkedIn

GitHub

Google Scholar

leadership

6 direct reports
team development
technical direction
delivery ownership

AI systems

production ML
evaluation/replay
model governance
applied AI tooling

data platforms

Kafka/Flink
Python/Java/Kotlin
SQL/AWS/GCP
CI/CD/observability

practice

design reviews
data contracts
local E2E tests
mentoring/hiring

profile

Engineering Manager with 16 years across production ML, data platforms, backend engineering and AI research. I lead cross-functional teams that turn complex data and model behaviour into dependable services. I bring hands-on experience in high-volume streaming, model evaluation, MLOps, technical roadmaps and team development, supported by a Ph.D. in Computer Science and practical AI standards work.

experience

Vortexa Ltd, London, UK 12/2020–present

Engineering Manager | ML Systems Lead

Lead technical direction and delivery for a live ML/data estate processing **~6M vessel-position records/hour** for **13.5K monitored vessels**. Manage **6 direct reports** and lead a **10-person cross-functional team**. Engineering Manager since **02/2022**; joined as Senior ML Engineer.

- **People & Delivery:** Manage six direct reports across Data Science, Data Engineering, Product and domain analysis; own performance and career development, team delivery, and hiring for six roles. Contributed hiring, onboarding and engineering practices as Data Production grew from 4 to 30+.
- **Production ML:** Led research-to-production delivery for destination and arrival-time sequence/transformer models in **PyTorch**; established MLflow, model/data versioning, evaluation gates, monitoring and versioned model-serving workflows.
- **Evaluation & Reliability:** Built batch/online evaluation and replay loops; investigated edge cases with domain experts and Product. Maintained data-signal controls, live accuracy monitoring, rollback/fallback paths and shared on-call practices.
- **Platform Architecture:** Led the **Kafka Streams-to-Flink** transition, improving maintainability, operational visibility and compute scaling independent of Kafka partitioning; linked streaming enrichment with prediction services and downstream products.
- **Engineering Standards:** Standardised I/O seams, schema/data validation, repository patterns and local end-to-end tests. Cut a **3-hour DAG feedback loop to under 5 minutes**; promoted ADRs, design reviews and runbooks.
- **Technical Roadmap:** Ran cross-functional workshops to settle model-quality definitions, set measurable objectives and prioritise work across engineering, Product, analysts and subject-matter experts.

DataReply, London, UK 04/2016–12/2020

Senior Consultant | Data Scientist / ML Engineer

Joined the London spin-off as its first consultant and contributed to growth to **30+ consultants**. Progressed to Senior Consultant, leading client delivery, scoping technical roadmaps, mentoring colleagues and coordinating enterprise engagements.

- **Vodafone I ML Platform:** Led multi-workstream delivery for a GCP/Kubeflow data-science platform, covering migration planning, CI/CD, workflow automation, feature engineering and ML lifecycle support.
- **CNHi I Predictive Maintenance:** Lead Data Scientist/Scrum Master on live agricultural-vehicle telemetry; guided a PySpark DS/DE team building time-series models and maintenance alerting from stakeholder requirements.
- **UBS I Real-Time Analytics:** Delivered Kafka/Elasticsearch pipelines, graph and process-mining analytics, and observability; developed production ML engineering practice through XP and pair programming.

KCL, UCL, David Game College, UK 2010–2016

Teaching and Technical Training

Taught algorithms, databases, data structures and Java/Python; developed clear technical communication and mentoring practice.

education

2010–2014	Ph.D. in Computer Science <i>Thesis: Persuasion Dialogues & Opponent Modelling.</i> Developed logical inference methods for large knowledge graphs, combining symbolic reasoning, graph analytics and Bayesian techniques (MCMC) . Received Best Poster Award at IJCAI 2013 (413 submissions), EPSRC PhD Scholarship, Outstanding TA Award and Graduate Certificate in Academic Practice. Publications on Google Scholar	King's College London, UK
2004–2010	Diploma (BEng) in Computer Engineering Five-year polytechnic degree with a strong mathematics foundation. Majored in Artificial Intelligence.	University of Thessaly, GR
2002–2004	Military Officer: Second Lieutenant Completed national service as a commissioned Second Lieutenant.	National Guard, CY

research & AI standards

since 10/2024	University College London, Dept. of Information Studies Research and teach practical AI standardisation, including auditability, model/data versioning, explainability and responsible adoption.	Associate Researcher
since 2021	ISO / CEN-CENELEC AI standardisation Contribute to AI standards aligned with EU policy and international norms, with emphasis on traceability, explainability and model/data governance.	Committee Expert JTC 21, WG3

selected applied AI & platform work

Private project	Promet Hands-on exploration of assistant runtime boundaries, streaming, tool routing, approvals, durable state, traceability and deterministic replay. Personal project; not an enterprise production platform.	Local applied AI harness
PyPI	dynamicio Created a Python library that makes I/O boundaries explicit, validates schema/data expectations and speeds local pipeline testing; used across 15+ repositories .	Data contracts
PyPI / JetBrains	skeleton-replay & plugin Open-source Python tooling and an IDE plugin for traces, architecture snapshots, replayable reports and source navigation.	Runtime evidence

selected talks & interviews

2023	Agile in Action Agile data science and the engineering/delivery journey at Vortexa.	Podcast Interview
2022	Open Data Science Conference dynamicio: abstracting I/O for ML workflows.	Industry Conference Talk

selected credentials

2016–2020	ML, cloud & data engineering AWS Machine Learning Specialty (2020); Google Professional Data Engineer (2017); Apache Spark Developer (2016).	AWS, Google Cloud, O'Reilly
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